

Standard Laptop Orders

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

SCENARIO

Requesting, approving, fulfilling and receiving a standard laptop

1 Entice

How does someone initially become aware of this process?

2 Enter

What do people experience as they begin the process?

3 Engage

In the core moments in the process, what happens?

4 Exit

What do people typically experience as the process finishes?

5 Extend

What happens after the experience is over?

S Steps

What does the person (or group) typically experience?

- 1 Need a laptop Portal**
A new hire or a staff member with an old device realises they need a laptop.
- 2 Open Service Portal**
The employee opens the IT Service Portal on web or mobile.
- 3 Search catalog Portal**
They search or browse for 'laptop' in the catalog.
- 4 View laptop details**
They open the Standard Laptop item, specs, cost and delivery estimate.
- 5 Fill order form**
They complete name, location and justification on a short form.
- 6 Submit request email**
They submit and a request number is generated.
- 7 Confirmation email**
An email confirms the request and explains the next steps.
- 8 Appraisal requested**
Flow Designer sends an approval to the manager.
- 9 Approve or reject**
The manager decides, low-cost orders can auto-approve.
- 10 Check stock**
The flow queries inventory for a matching device.
- 11 Reserve or order**
In stock, reserve it. Out of stock, reserve a purchase order.
- 12 Image & prepare**
IT deployment images and configures the device.
- 13 Ship or ready**
The employee is notified of shipping or desk pickup.
- 14 Receive laptop**
The employee collects or receives the device.
- 15 Confirm receipt**
They confirm. The receipt is in the portal or by email.
- 16 Request closes**
The flow closes the request and updates the asset record.
- 17 Asset on profile**
The laptop shows under the employee's assigned equipment.
- 18 Satisfaction survey**
A short survey is sent after closure.
- 19 Refresh reminders**
Reminders about warranty and device refresh are scheduled.
- 20 Flow metrics review**
IT reviews cycle time, approvals and error rates.

I Interactions

What interactions do they have at each step along the way?

People: Who do they see or talk to?
Places: What are they?
Things: What digital touchpoints or objects would they use?

- HR onboarding, notice, manager, or an ageing device
- Service Portal on browser or mobile
- Catalog search bar and categories
- Catalog item page with specs, cost and delivery estimate
- Catalog form on the portal, user details pre-filled
- Submit button; request number generated
- Employee email inbox
- Manager's email re appraisal requested
- Manager; reason entered on rejection
- Inventory and asset table queried by the flow, no human
- Procurement or vendor system via REST integrations/faults
- IT deployment team and imaging tools
- Email or portal notification; courier tracking
- Desk pickup or courier delivery; IT staff
- Portal 'Received' button or email link
- No interaction: the flow closes the request automatically
- My Assets section of the portal
- Survey email or portal pop-up
- Email reminders from asset management
- Platform Analytics dashboards; IT service owner

G Goals & motivations

At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")

- Help me get a working laptop for my job
- Help me find the right place to ask
- Help me avoid wading through models I can't order
- Help me know what I will get and when
- Help me avoid typing what the system already knows
- Help me know my request went through
- Help me trust it is recorded and know what's next
- Help me decide quickly without a long email chain
- Help me avoid waiting on a decision
- Help me get the right device without delay
- Help IT avoid manual orders and data-entry errors
- Help me start work with a ready device
- Help me know when it arrives
- Help me get set up quickly
- Help me avoid extra paperwork
- Help me stop worrying about open requests
- Help me see what equipment I had
- Help me give feedback easily
- Help me avoid surprise end-of-life devices
- Help IT see what to improve

P Positive moments

What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delighted, or exciting?

- One-click approval straight from email
- Auto-approval under the cost threshold
- Stock is checked in seconds
- Orders and asset records are created automatically
- Proactive status updates at each stage
- Device arrives pre-configured
- Request closes itself
- Employee sees assigned equipment
- Cycle time falls and is visible

N Negative moments

What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?

- Employees are unsure what they are entitled to
- Long forms feel like effort
- Managers are slow to approve
- Requests arrive without a clear reason
- Stock data can be out of date
- A vendor API failure can stall the order
- Imaging lags at busy times
- Shipping delays outside IT's control
- Employees forget to confirm receipt
- Low survey response

E Experience curve

How does the person feel at each step? Higher means more delighted; lower means more frustrated.



A Areas of opportunity

Here might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?

- Trigger the request automatically from HR onboarding
- Recommend one laptop by role or department
- Pre-fill name, location and cost from the profile
- Delegate approvals, send timed reminders with escalation
- Begin a reason code on rejection
- Reorder stock at approval time
- Add entry and an IT alert on integration errors
- Pre-stage images for common roles
- Show a live status tracker in the portal
- Use a one-click 'Received' confirmation
- Keep the survey to one question
- Schedule refresh reminders from asset age
- Dashboard cycle time, approval time and error rate